

May 5, 2026

Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - MACH Alliance

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Attachments  Agent Ecosystem Working Group 1: Enterprise Agent Architecture - M...

Summary

The working group established an enterprise agent architecture focus and decided to define key agent terminology.

Group Introductions and Charter

Participants introduced their professional backgrounds in AI and MACH ecosystem roles. The group defined its primary mission as establishing enterprise technical architectures for integrating agentic systems.

Establishing Agent Definitions

The group debated the technical definition of an agent, distinguishing

between deterministic automation and probabilistic LLM-based loops. They decided to form a small working group to finalize a formal opinion document on what constitutes an agent.

Focus on Actionable Outcomes

Members prioritized the creation of practical research and technical artifacts over theoretical principles. Future efforts will emphasize developing actionable guidance, reference architectures, and potential hackathon workshops for the community.

Next steps

- ☐ [Rebecca Veldon] Publicize Repository: Ensure the GitHub repository is public and accessible to all members.
- ☐ [Rebecca Veldon] Establish Slack: Investigate feasibility and create a dedicated Slack channel for the working group collaboration.
- ☐ [George Fitzgibbons] Draft Agent Definition: Lead the collaborative effort to draft a foundational article defining the MACH Alliance opinion on what constitutes an agent.
- ☐ [The group] Submit Ideas: Add all white paper, hackathon, or answer ideas as issues in the GitHub project issue tracker.

Details

- **Logistics and Opening Remarks:** The initial discussion focused on general greetings, time zone challenges for coordinating the meeting across the US West Coast and Central Europe, and brief introductions to the attendees' locations and roles. Everett Zufelt mentioned they were working on an RFP response, and George Fitzgibbons advised against joining meetings while on PTO. Rebecca Veldon noted that they were admitting attendees as they arrived.

- **Meeting Agenda and Co-Chairs:** Rebecca Veldon outlined the meeting agenda, which included introductions, reviewing the working group's scope and objectives, getting GitHub handles set up, and prioritizing deliverables related to enterprise agent architecture. George Fitzgibbons was introduced as a co-chair who was present, while the other co-chair, Tim Bennett, was currently on PTO.
- **George Fitzgibbons' Introduction and Background:** George Fitzgibbons introduced himself as working on the field engineering team at Versel, focusing on understanding customer workloads, deployment, and infrastructure management for agents. Their interest in the working group is to establish patterns for deploying agents, particularly concerning enterprise security and control plane architecture. They also noted that GitHub would serve as the source of truth for the group's projects and architecture.
- **Rebecca Veldon's Role:** Rebecca Veldon introduced themselves as the data and systems manager for the MACH Alliance, stating their role is to provide administrative support and help with anything the group needs.
- **Sana Remekie's Introduction and Concia's Mission:** Sana Remekie, CEO and co-founder of Concia, explained that their company provides the orchestration layer in the MACH stack, helping large brands become "agent ready". This is achieved by creating an API layer and a semantic foundation on top of customers' existing legacy systems like SAP and Salesforce, enabling agents to interact more easily with these back-end systems.
- **Devon Hillard's Introduction and Focus:** Devon Hillard, Principal Architect at McFaten Digital, shared their 25 years of experience in enterprise e-commerce technology, including architecture and hosting. Their current focus is running the AI practice for McFaten Digital, which specializes in B2B and marketplace customers, leveraging agentic services, LLMs, and ML to solve complex business problems.
- **Ryan Lunka's Introduction:** Ryan Lunka, Head of the AI practice for Aries, a digital transformation consultancy and long-time MACH Alliance member, introduced themselves. They run Aries' internal AI transformation and lead their go-to-market strategy for AI services, mainly serving upper mid-market and lower enterprise retailers, with some B2B work.
- **Doug Wessel's Introduction and Vax's Platform:** Doug Wessel, who leads co-innovation engineering at Vax, explained that Vax is a revenue execution platform and a relatively new MACH member. Vax functions as a layer on top of

traditional ERP and CRM systems, orchestrating and taking capabilities to focus specifically on the revenue and sales side of the business.

- **Morten Næss' Introduction:** Morten Næss, CTO of Blue Stone PIM, is a long-standing MACH Alliance member and has been the Head of Admissions for the past four years. They identified themselves as an "AI nerd".
- **Daniele Stroppa's Introduction:** Daniele Stroppa leads the technical strategy for retail and consumer goods partners at AWS, supporting solution providers and customers in building, scaling, and deploying systems on AWS. Their current work is largely focused on enabling partners and customers to build agentic solutions.
- **Ashwin Mudaliar's Introduction and MRA Framework:** Ashwin Mudaliar works on go-to-market and partnerships at MRA, an open-source TypeScript framework for building agent systems. They noted MRA's focus is shifting from developer experience to the commercial side, with the thesis being to enable the 18 million web developers to transition to the AI space using a familiar TypeScript stack.
- **Working Group Charter and Scope:** Everett Zufelt provided background on the working group, stating its core mission is to focus on the enterprise technical architecture of integrating agentic systems into end-user organizations, rather than teaching how to build an agent. The group intends to address how to manage multiple agents, agent coordination, safety, and establishing a working definition of what an "agent" means within this context.
- **Desired Outcomes and Deliverables:** Sana Remekie asked if the goal was to create best practice documentation and technical architecture documentation, which Everett Zufelt confirmed, stating the group wants to share reference architectures, best practices, and thought leadership with the broader MACH Alliance and community. Rebecca Veldon displayed the suggested research topics and proposed artifacts from the charter, which include frameworks for multi-agent coordination, service integration, and observability architecture for agent systems.
- **Defining "Agent" for the Group:** George Fitzgibbons suggested defining "what an agent is" as an important first step, noting the term is nebulous and means different things to different people. Sana Remekie proposed a definition where an agent is an entity empowered to decide and act on its own based on observing its current reality and context, distinguishing it from simple deterministic automation.

- **Technical Definition of Agent:** The technical discussion coalesced around the idea that an agent must involve an LLM, use tools in a loop to accomplish tasks, and possess a probabilistic nature for decision-making, which differentiates it from strictly deterministic code. Ashwin Mudaliar added that in the MRA framework, agents solve open-ended tasks where the specific steps are unknown until the loop closes, working alongside deterministic workflows and tools.
- **Pragmatic Approach to Agent Definition:** Everett Zufelt and Devon Hillard advocated for a more pragmatic definition of an agent that includes systems using an LLM as part of their operation, such as for sentiment analysis, even if they return a result to a traditional deterministic service. This approach acknowledges the reality of what vendors and customers are currently building, which tends to be more about "agentic capabilities".
- **Proposal for Definitional Alignment:** Everett Zufelt suggested that George Fitzgibbons organize a small group to work on an opinion document, which would anchor the MACH Alliance's point of view on "what an agent is" to prevent repeated debate in future meetings. George Fitzgibbons agreed that anchoring a definition is critical for establishing spectrums of agency.
- **Call for Actionable Guidance:** Devon Hillard stressed the importance of providing direct, actionable guidance, tools, and technology to the community quickly, contrasting this with the risk of spending too much time on broad, "White Tower architecture" principles.
- **Focus on Building and Hackathons:** George Fitzgibbons expressed a desire to move towards a hackathon or workshop format where people can build and deploy enterprise agents easily, aligning with the idea that the barrier to entry for building agents is low.
- **Next Steps and Administrative Items:** Everett Zufelt summarized the next steps: ensure the GitHub repository is public, encourage members to add ideas for white papers, actions, or hackathons as issues in the GitHub project, and have a small group collaborate on a recommended opinion article defining an agent. Rebecca Veldon committed to looking into setting up a dedicated Slack channel for the working group.

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